

Board 1

West Deals

None Vul

♠ J T 9 6 4

♥ 9 8 3 2

♦ -

♣ Q T 6 3

♠ K Q 7 3

♥ A 4

♦ Q 9 6 2

♣ A 8 4

	N	
W		E
	S	

♠ 8

♥ K Q T 7 5

♦ T 8 4

♣ J 9 5 2

♠ A 5 2

♥ J 6

♦ A K J 7 5 3

♣ K 7

West	North	East	South
Pass	1NT	Pass	3♦
Pass	4♦	Pass	4NT
Pass	5♥	Pass	7NT
All Pass			

7NT by North

become the odds-on favorite to hold the ♠ Guard. His ♠ discard makes it very likely that he started with 5 ♠s.

North is to play 7NT. East leads the ♥K.

With 12 obvious tricks your first thought should be that perhaps the ♠s will split 3-3.

Then, your second thought should be that dummy's ♥J is a Threat against East's ♥Q, so if it is East who holds 4 ♠s you will be able to squeeze him.

Since the contract is 7NT you take the first trick with the ♥A.

With one trick in the bag you should test ♦s next. When you play the ♦A West discards a ♠.

You continue with the ♦Q and ♦K, West discarding a ♥ and a ♣.

Since West has shown up with a ♦ void he has become the odds-on favorite to hold the ♠ Guard. His ♠ discard makes it very likely that he started with 5 ♠s.

To find out for sure you play ♠A, then ♠Q. Sure enough East discards a ♥ on the second round.

You can't squeeze East in ♥s and ♠s because he doesn't hold the ♠ Guard, West does.

But now a completely new possibility shows up. Say to yourself, over and over, "East must guard ♥s, and West must guard ♠s. Nobody can guard ♣s."

You start playing dummy's ♦ winners.

With one more ♦ in dummy, things look like this.

When you play the ♦5 West must keep both ♠s to guard against your ♠7. So he discards the ♣6, hoping partner can stop that suit.

Your ♠7 is now worthless so you throw it.

East has no problem, (yet), he discards the ♥10.

[showcards N:S5,HJ,CK,C7 E:SJ,ST,CQ,CT S:SK,CA,C8,C4 W:HQ,CJ,C9,C5]

It is now time to pressure East.

Play dummy's ♠5 to your ♠K.

East MUST keep his ♥Q so he releases his ♣5.

And you win the last three tricks with ♣K, ♣A, ♣8.

This is called a Double Squeeze.

Board 2

South Deals

None Vul

♠ Q J T 8 3

♥ J T 7 2

♦ 6 3

♣ T 6

♠ 9 5 2

♥ 6

♦ A J 9 7 4

♣ Q 8 4 3

	N	
W		E
	S	

♠ 6

♥ Q 9 8 4 3

♦ 8 5 2

♣ J 9 7 5

♠ A K 7 4

♥ A K 5

♦ K Q T

♣ A K 2

West	North	East	South
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2 ♣

Pass	3 ♦	Pass	4NT
------	-----	------	-----

Pass	5 ♦	Pass	7NT
------	-----	------	-----

All Pass

7NT by South

Play 4 rounds of ♦ s.

[showcards N:S9,H6,D4,C8 E:HQ,H9,H8,CJ S:S7,HA,HK,H5 W:SJ,HJ,HT,H7]

On the fourth ♦ East had to discard a ♥. You discarded a small ♠. West discarded a ♠ on the third ♦ and a ♥ on the fourth.

Play dummy's ♦ 4. East cannot throw the ♣ J or he will set up dummy's ♣ 8, so he discards a ♥.

You discard the ♠ 7.

Now West is squeezed. He cannot discard the ♠ J or he will set up dummy's ♠ 9, so he discards a ♥.

You win the last three ♥ tricks with another Double Squeeze.

South is to play 7NT. West leads the ♠ Q.

One more winner is needed. Dummy's fourth ♣ is a possibility.

So take the ♠ K and play ♣ A K Q.

West discards a ♠ on the third ♣.

Now you know East guards the ♣ s.

Before tackling ♦ s, see what you can discover about ♠ s.

Play the ♠ A. East discards a ♥.

East guards the ♣ s. West guards the ♠ s. Nobody can guard the ♥ s.

Board 3

North Deals

E-W Vul

♠ Q 6 2
 ♥ 7 5 2
 ♦ J 9 8 4 3
 ♣ J 4

♠ 5

♥ A K J 9 8 3

♦ A 5

♣ K 8 6 3

	N	
W		E
	S	

♠ A K J 9 4

♥ 6 4

♦ T 7 2

♣ Q T 2

♠ T 8 7 3

♥ Q T

♦ K Q 6

♣ A 9 7 5

West	North	East	South
	1♥	1♠	2♣
Pass	3♥	Pass	4♥
Pass	4NT	Pass	5♦
Pass	6♥		
All Pass			
6♥ by North			

Now play the ♦ A, ♦ K, and ♦ Q, discarding the ♣ 3 from your hand.

Then lead dummy's ♣ 7 to your ♣ K.

[showcards N:ST,CA,C9 E:DJ,D9,CJ S:HA,C8,C6 W:SJ,CQ,CT]

Here you are in your hand.

Only East can guard dummy's ♠ T, and only East can guard dummy's ♣ 9.

So you play your ♥ A and East must give up one of his guards. If he holds on to the ♠ J then you toss dummy's useless ♠ T. If he throws the ♠ J then you toss dummy's ♣ 9.

North is to play 6♥. East leads the ♠ A, then ♠ K.

When you looked at just your and dummy's cards on the previous page it may have looked impossible to find a twelfth winner.

Even looking at all four hands here it is still very difficult to come up with a plan.

Here's a hint: If East holds 3 ♣s, (and you see that he does), can you squeeze him in ♣s and ♠s?

Of course you ruffed the ♠ K.

The big problem with trying to squeeze East in the black suits right now is that West actually holds a ♠ guard. But you can fix that.

Play dummy's ♥ Q and ♥ 10, then ruff a ♠, then pull the last trump.

Board 4

South Deals

None Vul

♠ A K 9 3 2

♥ T 4 2

♦ J 9

♣ J 6 4

♠ Q T

♥ K Q 5 3

♦ A 8 6 3

♣ 8 5 2

	N	
W		E
	S	

♠ 8 6 5

♥ J 9 8 6

♦ Q T 4

♣ Q T 9

♠ J 7 4

♥ A 7

♦ K 7 5 2

♣ A K 7 3

West	North	East	South
			1NT
Pass	2♣	Pass	2♦
Pass	3NT		
All Pass			
3NT by South			

At trick 2 you play a ♠.

Of course West will win this with his ♠K.

And he will no doubt continue with the ♠A and ♠9.

You discard 2 ♦s from dummy and a ♣ from your hand.

East cannot spare either a ♥ or a ♦ so he also throws a ♣.

Remember this position

West will almost surely cash his ♠2.

You and dummy both discard a ♣ and East also must discard a ♣.

It doesn't matter what West plays next, let's say it is a ♣.

In your hand with the ♣K, you now play the ♣A.

East is truly squeezed. If he discards a ♥, dummy's ♥5 will become a winner. but if he discards a ♦ then you will get a third ♦ trick and the contract.

Since it was West who started the squeeze by cashing his last ♠, this is called a Suicide Squeeze. **BUT**, what if West had not cashed that ♠?

Here is the position you were supposed to remember

Suppose West is a really expert defender and avoids the Suicide Squeeze by just refusing to cash his winning ♠. It doesn't matter what else he plays instead, so let us assume it is a ♣.

You win in your hand and establish a ♦ winner by playing ♦A, ♦K, and a small ♦. East wins but cannot reach his partner's hand for that good ♠.

South is to play 3NT. West leads the ♠3. East plays the ♠5.

From the opening lead of ♠3 and East's play of ♠5 you should have deduced that West held five ♠s to the A K. Therefore if you lose a trick in any other suit West will be able to take 4 ♠ tricks and defeat you.

You have 8 winners, and if East holds 4+ ♥s AND 3+ ♦s then only he can guard the two suits.

But how can you squeeze him?

The answer to that question is that **YOU** cannot squeeze him.

But maybe you can make his partner do the job for you.

Board 5

North Deals

N-S Vul

♠ T 7 5 4 2

♥ J T 2

♦ Q T 4 3

♣ 4

♠ A

♥ A 6 3

♦ K 5

♣ A K Q J 9 8 7

	N	
W		E
	S	

♠ K Q 9 6 3

♥ Q 9 8 5

♦ 9

♣ T 6 2

♠ J 8

♥ K 7 4

♦ A J 8 7 6 2

♣ 5 3

West	North	East	South
	2♣	Pass	3♦
Pass	4NT	Pass	5♦
Pass	5NT	Pass	6♦
Pass	7♣		
All Pass			

7♣ by North
into a Threat card against West's ♦Q.

But, the ♠J is already a Threat card against East's ♠Q.

Play your ♣J and ♣9, discarding the ♦8 and the ♥4 from dummy.

East can afford to discard the ♠9 and the ♥5.

West can spare his two ♠s.

[showcards N:SJ,HK,H7,DJ E:HJ,HT,H2,DQ S:HA,H6,H3,C8 W:SQ,HQ,H9,H8]

You are there. Play your ♣8.

East cannot throw the ♠Q, so he gives up the ♥8. Dummy's ♠J is of no further value so you dump it.

West cannot throw the ♦Q, so he gives up the ♥2.

And you take the last three tricks with the ♥ suit. There were only two defenders; one of them had to guard ♠s and the other had to guard ♦s. There was nobody left to guard ♥s.

North is to play 7♣. East leads the ♠K.

At first glance this doesn't appear to be a difficult hand. You expect to win the opening lead, pull trumps, then establish a ♦ winner by playing ♦K, ♦A, and ruffing a ♦. As long as they split 3-2 you could reach dummy's ♦ winner with the ♥K.

So you take the ♠A, pull three rounds of trumps and play ♦K.

But when you lead to the ♦A East discards a small ♠.

Time to rethink. You are in dummy now, and you can ruff a ♦, return with the ♥K and ruff another ♦. The last ♦ would be good but you'd have no way to reach it.

Think squeeze instead. Ruff a ♦. This turns the ♦J

Board 6

South Deals

None Vul

♠ A K J 8 6 5 3 2		♠ T 9 7
♥ 8 6 2		♥ 4
♦ T		♦ Q J 9 4 2
♣ 7		♣ J T 9 3
	♠ -	
	♥ A K Q T 5	
	♦ A 8 6 3	
	♣ A K Q 4	

West	North	East	South
4♠	Pass	Pass	2♣
Pass	6♥		5♥
All Pass			

6♥ by South

either one is going to do the same thing. Assume West wins the ♦ 10.

He will then play the ♠ K, which you must ruff in your hand.

Now play a small ♦ to dummy's ♦ K.

[showcards N:HJ,D7,C8,C6 E:DQ,DJ,CJ,CT S:DA,D8,CQ,C4 W:SJ,S8,S6,S5]

You are in dummy, ready for the squeeze.

Play dummy's ♥ J.

East gets to choose his own fate - discarding a protector in one of the two suits. Of course, whichever suit he discards you will throw the opposite one.

Yet another slam, courtesy of the Squeeze Play!

South is to play 6♥. West leads the ♠ A.

If ♦s and ♣s split nicely this would be an easy slam. But with that wild ♠ bid by West you can't expect decent splits.

So you ruff the ♠, pull trumps in three rounds, then play ♣ A K and get the bad news when West discards a ♠.

You now know that East guards the ♣s. And since West had 3 ♥s and a very long ♠ suit it is pretty likely that East guards the ♦s also. You will try to squeeze East in ♣s and ♦s, but first you must lose a trick to rectify the count.

So you play a low ♦ from each hand.

It doesn't matter which defender takes the ♦, since